



PARISH BULLETIN

Sunday 6 September 2026
Twenty Third Sunday in Ordinary Time

Fr Francis O'Brien

CONTACTS

Parish Office: 028 90 324597

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Office hours 10.30am – 2.00pm Tuesday -Thursday, closes 1pm on Friday.

You can contact us by telephone or email. Since St Patrick's is a very busy Parish Office; we can't always answer the phone immediately. Please leave a message with your telephone number and we will call you back.

Parish email: stpatricks@downandconnor.org

Website: www.stpatricks.org

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St Patrick's Parish is a member of a Family of Parishes comprising the Parishes of Holy Family, St Gerards and St Patrick's.

Holy Family – Fr Michael Spence, Fr John O' Lavery (028 90 743119)

St Gerards – Fr Patrick O'Keeffe (028 90 774833)

Belfast Jesuit Centre: Fr Gerry Clarke SJ
gclarke@jesuit.ie

St Patrick's Primary School: 028 90 351478

Blessed Trinity College: 028 90 370665

WEEKEND MASS

Saturday Vigil 6pm. Sunday Morning 9am & 11am.
Sunday Evening 6pm Candlelit Mass.

WEEKDAY MASS Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday 10am.

CONFESSIONS Saturdays 5.30pm to 5.50pm.

REST IN PEACE

Inurnment: Jim Meighan.



MASS INTENTIONS FOR THE COMING WEEK

Saturday 6pm: Jim Meighan Months Mind, In Memory of Deceased Members of the Cosgrove Family.

Sunday 9am: Albert Gibson Anniversary.

Sunday 6pm: Eddie Brannigan 3rd Anniversary.

Tuesday 10am: Seamus Brady Anniversary, In Memory of James and Jean Flanagan.

Wednesday 10am: In Memory of Annie and George Madine.

BAPTISMS IN ST PATRICKS

We welcomed to the Family of God this Summer.....

Caiden, Rosie Mae, Harper, Olivia, Kayden, Ava and Eadaoin. *As a Parish we pray that the Lord protects them, strengthens them and helps them continue shining their light.*

FEAST/MEMORIAL DAYS THIS WEEK

Tuesday 8 September – The Nativity of the Blessed Virgin Mary. We celebrate the Nativity of Mary, who brought the dawn of hope and salvation to the world. She is the true Ark of the Covenant, the Temple of God, because her body received the one Mediator.

Wednesday 9 September - St Ciaran, was born in Roscommon around 512. He came to Clonmacnoise in January 545 where he founded a monastery which was to become one of the most renowned in Europe. He died at the age of 33 while the monastery was still being built.

Thursday 10 September - St Peter Claver, born in Catalonia 1580, a member of the Society of Jesus (Jesuits). In 1610 he was sent to Cartagena in Colombia and worked for 33 years among the slaves until his death in 1654. During a tireless ministry he is said to have baptised more than 300,000.

Saturday 12 September - The Most Holy Name of Mary. This Feast was included in the Roman Calendar in 1684 to celebrate the victory over the Turks at Vienna in 1683.

NEW LODGE GROTTTO 50th BIRTHDAY CELEBRATIONS

Monday 7 September

6.30pm Rosary at the Grotto

7pm Holy Mass at the Grotto

Followed by Refreshments. **All**

Welcome! With Fr Francis O'Brien and Fr John O'Lavery.



TWENTY THIRD SUNDAY OF THE YEAR

On Fraternal Correction

The question in today's Gospel is not forgiveness, but the sin of one member of the community. Every effort is to be made to bring the erring person to repentance, first in private, then before a few, finally, before the whole community. If he is still unrepentant, he must be excommunicated. The decision of the Church will be honoured by God, since God inspired them in making that decision. The harsh phrase 'treat him as a pagan or a tax collector' reflects the strict Jewish Christianity of Matthew's Church. The First Reading talks about the grave responsibility leaders of the community have to try to correct the erring.

READINGS: First Reading (Ezek 33:7-9). The appointed leaders bear the responsibility to point out to wrong-doers the error of their ways and to try to get them to reform. Second Reading (Rom 13:8-10). If we truly loved our neighbours, we would not harm them in any way. Gospel (Mt 18:15-20). We hear about the duty of a Christian to correct an erring brother or sister. But there is a proper way of doing it.

OPENING MASS FOR THE SEASON OF CREATION

Sunday, 6th September 6pm in St. Patrick's Church, Donegall Street, Belfast. Celebrant: Fr Piaras Jackson marking the beginning of the Season of Creation (1 Sept-4 Oct), a time when Christians worldwide commit to prayer and action for our common home under the theme "Living Water".

RCIA A JOURNEY IN FAITH

Thinking about becoming a Catholic, or wanting to deepen your understanding of the faith?

The Diocesan RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) is a journey of faith, formation and community for adults wishing to explore the teachings of Jesus Christ and the Catholic Church. It is open to anyone unbaptised, those baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics wishing to reconnect with their faith.

The 2026-2027 programme begins on Wednesday 23 September in St Mary's Hall, Chapel Lane, Belfast. Sessions include prayer, teaching, discussion and time for questions.

All are welcome, whether you are exploring the faith for the first time or returning after time away.

To find out more email rcia@downandconnor.org

DOWN & CONNOR DIOCESAN RETREAT

13TH – 16TH SEPTEMBER As Fr Francis will be attending the retreat there will be no weekday Mass Tuesday 15 and Wednesday 16 September.

PRAYER OF THE WEEK

We wish all the students and teachers of the schools in our Parish best wishes for the new school year.

A BACK-TO-SCHOOL PRAYER

Loving God, thank you for the rest and relaxation we enjoyed over the summer.

Today, we pray for our children as they begin their new school year.

Bless them with joy at seeing friends, excitement at new experiences, and a love of learning. Watch over all who learn, replacing fear with joy, anxiety with peace, and tiredness with energy.

Grant teachers wisdom, patience, and joy in serving their students.

In Jesus' name we pray.

Amen.

THOUGHT FOR THE WEEK

"September is a gentle reminder: you are capable of change."

NOT DEAD YET UK

There are cards available in the Church to vote against the **Second Reading of The Assisted Dying Bill**. Please lend your support to those campaigning for disabled people to be assisted in living, not dying. **The Second Reading of the Bill in the House of Commons takes place on September 11**, please fill in and send your vote against it before that date.

PARISH COLLECTIONS

The Offertory Collection for Sunday 30 August came to £1866.00. Dona £135.00.

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If you wish to donate directly via Bank Transfer the parish bank details are:

Account Name: St Patricks Parish

Account Number: 70327727

Sort Code: 95-06-79 (please add an identifying name to your transaction) or you can contact the Parish Office for a Standing Order Form.

Thank you for your continued support and generosity.

